

Once In Royal David's City

Cecil Frances Alexander, 1848

Simple accordion

H.J. Gauntlett, 1858

Irby 87.87.77.

arr Humphrey Drummond

The musical score is written for a simple accordion in the key of B-flat major (two flats) and 4/4 time. The melody is presented on a single staff with a treble clef. Chord symbols (C, F, C7, Bb, Gm) are placed above the staff to indicate the harmonic accompaniment. The lyrics are written in a traditional hymn style, with line breaks corresponding to the musical phrases. The score is divided into six systems, each containing a line of music and its corresponding lyrics.

Once in roy - al Da - vid's ci - ty
 He came down to earth from hea - ven
 And, through all His won - drous child - hood
 For He is our child - hood's pat - tern,
 And our eyes at last shall see Him,
 Not in that poor low - ly sta - ble,

Stood a low - ly cat - tle shed,
 Who is God and Lord of all,
 He would hon - our and o - bey,
 Day by day like us He grew;
 Through His own re - deem - ing love,
 With the ox - en stand - ing by,

Where a mo - ther laid her ba - by
 And His shel - ter was a sta - ble
 Love, and watch the low - ly mai - den
 He was lit - tle, weak, and help - less,
 For that Child so dear and gen - tle
 We shall see Him; but in hea - ven,

In a man - ger for His bed:
 And his cra - dle was a stall;
 In whose gen - tle arms He lay:
 Tears and smiles like us He knew;
 Is our Lord in heaven a - bove;
 Set at God's right hand on high;
 Bb F Gm F

Ma - ry was that mo - ther mild
 With the poor, and mean, and low-ly
 Christ - ian child - ren all be
 And He feel - eth for our sad-ness,
 And He leads His child - ren on
 When like stars His child - ren crowned

Je - sus Christ her lit - tle Child.
 Lived on earth our Sav - iour holy.
 Mild, O - bed - ient, good as he.
 And He shar - eth in our glad-ness
 To the place where He is gone.
 All in white shall wait a - round.

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